

Description	Keystroke	Function	Note
Load a session	PEL supports only one key binding to save a session (or desktop): <f11> S L The command is a dispatcher command that uses one of the available command from desktop, desktop+ or easysession.el as selected by the pel-use-desktop, the pel-use-easysession user-options and prompts.		
Load a session A dispatcher command that uses one of the commands below.	<f11> S L	(pel-session-load)	Load a session. Prompt for type (directory-specific or simple name) and the session or desktop name. This is a dispatcher command; it selects the command currently active as selected by the pel-use-desktop and pel-use-easysession user-options and may prompt the user. - Give priority to the easysession package (because it is more powerful and directly supported by the PEL e and ge scripts). Uses the following commands: - For easysession: pel-easysession-load easysession-switch-to easysession-switch-to-and-restore-geometry - For desktop: pel-desktop-load desktop-read desktop+-load desktop+-load-auto
• Load a session using easysession.el	(pel-easysession-load)		Session loading dispatch function for desktop-based session loading. Invokes one of the following function according to the value of pel-use-easysession user-option and prompt reply: easysession-switch-to easysession-switch-to-and-restore-geometry
• Load a session with easysession.el . No geometry change.	(easysession-switch-to SESSION-NAME)		Load a session without altering the frame's size or position. Prompts the user for a session name. - Save the current session if it is loaded and not being reloaded. - Requires ‘easysession-switch-to-save-session’ to be non-nil and ‘easysession-save-mode-predicate’ to evaluate to non-nil or be nil. - Load the specified session. - Set the specified session as the current session. If the session is already loaded, a message is displayed to indicate it has been reloaded. If the session is newly created or switched to, a message is displayed accordingly.
• Load a session with easysession.el . With graphical frame geometry update.	(easysession-switch-to-and-restore-geometry SESSION-NAME)		Load a session and restore the position and size of graphical Emacs frames. - Prompts the user for a session name when invoked interactively. - When ‘easysession-switch-to-save-session’ is non nil, it saves the current session before loading the session that is specified. - Save the current session if it is loaded and not being reloaded (when ‘easysession-switch-to-save-session’ is non nil.) - Load the specified session. - Set the specified session as the current session. If the session is already loaded, a message is displayed to indicate it has been reloaded. If the session is newly created or switched to, a message is displayed accordingly.
• Load a session using desktop or desktop+	(pel-desktop-load)		Session loading dispatch function for desktop-based session loading. Invokes one of the following function according to the value of pel-use-desktop user-option and prompt reply: desktop-read desktop+-load desktop+-load-auto
• Load a session by reading and processing a desktop file	(desktop-read DIRNAME)		Read and process the desktop file in directory DIRNAME. - Look for a desktop file in DIRNAME, or if DIRNAME is omitted, look in directories listed in ‘desktop-path’. If a desktop file is found, it is processed and ‘desktop-after-read-hook’ is run. If no desktop file is found, clear the desktop and run ‘desktop-no-desktop-file-hook’. - Interactively, with prefix arg C-u, ask for DIRNAME. - This function is a no-op when Emacs is running in batch mode. - It returns t if a desktop file was loaded, nil otherwise.
• Load a desktop+ named session previously created	(desktop+-load NAME)		Load a session previously created using ‘ desktop+-create ’. - NAME is the name which was given at session creation. When called interactively, it is asked in the minibuffer with auto-completion. - As a special case, if NAME is left blank, the session is automatically named after the current working directory.
• Load a desktop+ session previously created for the current directory	(desktop+-load-auto)		Load a session previously created using ‘ desktop+-create-auto ’. The session is identified by the current working directory.
Emacs built-in desktop.el	Emacs built-in desktop provides session management of buffers and windows (including the window layout: PEL ensures that window layout is controlled in terminal mode: normally Emacs only enables it in graphics mode.  PEL activates: - the standard desktop commands when the pel-use-desktop user option is set to: t, with-desktop-automatic, with-desktop-registry or with-desktop-registry-automatic. - automatic saving and restoring of sessions on Emacs startup when pel-use-desktop is set to with-desktop-automatic, or with-desktop-registry-automatic. - The following extra desktop commands are available on the following key bindings.		
Save current session in a directory	<f11> S D S	(desktop-save DIRNAME &optional RELEASE ONLY-IF-CHANGED VERSION)	Save the desktop in a desktop file. Prompts for DIRNAME: specifies where to save the desktop file.
Load a session by reading and processing a desktop file	<f11> S D L	(desktop-read DIRNAME)	Read and process the desktop file in directory DIRNAME. - Look for a desktop file in DIRNAME, or if DIRNAME is omitted, look in directories listed in ‘desktop-path’. If a desktop file is found, it is processed and ‘desktop-after-read-hook’ is run. If no desktop file is found, clear the desktop and run ‘desktop-no-desktop-file-hook’. - Interactively, with prefix arg C-u, ask for DIRNAME. - This function is a no-op when Emacs is running in batch mode. - It returns t if a desktop file was loaded, nil otherwise.
Toggle Desktop Save Mode	<f11> S D M-s	(desktop-save-mode &optional ARG)	Toggle desktop saving (Desktop Save mode), where desktop is automatically saved when Emacs terminates and also saved periodically. With a prefix argument ARG, enable Desktop Save mode if ARG is positive, and disable it otherwise.
	When Desktop Save mode is enabled, the state of Emacs is saved from one session to another. In particular, Emacs will save the desktop when it exits (this may prompt you; see the option ‘desktop-save’). The next time Emacs starts, if this mode is active it will restore the desktop. - To manually save the desktop at any time, use the command ‘<f11> S S’. - To load it, use ‘<f11> S L’. Once a desktop file exists, Emacs will auto-save it according to the option ‘desktop-auto-save-timeout’. - To see all the options you can set, browse the ‘desktop’ customization group, with: M-x customize-group desktop  Use this to turn on/off the current automatic saving of the session. It does not control whether Emacs will automatically load a session on startup.		
Clear current session - close all its buffers	<f11> S D C	(desktop-clear)	Empty the Desktop. - This kills all buffers except for internal ones and those with names matched by a regular expression in the list ‘desktop-clear-preserve-buffers’. - Furthermore, it clears the variables listed in ‘desktop-globals-to-clear’. - When called interactively and ‘desktop-restore-frames’ is non-nil, it also deletes all frames except the selected one (and its minibuffer frame, if different). - Prompt for saving modified buffers visiting files.
Changed to a session saved in a different directory	<f11> S D D	(desktop-change-dir DIRNAME)	Change to desktop saved in DIRNAME. Kill the desktop as specified by variables ‘desktop-save-mode’ and ‘desktop-save’, then clear the desktop and load the desktop file in directory DIRNAME.
Revert to last loaded session	<f11> S D R	(desktop-revert)	Revert to the last loaded desktop.

Description	Keystroke	Function	Note
Using desktop-registry	When using the desktop-registry , the desktop-registry commands listed below are available. The Emacs built-in desktop.el commands described above are also available.  The desktop-registry external package provides the following commands.  PEL activates the commands when the pel-use-desktop user option is set to with-dektop-registry or with-desktop-registry-automatic . It activates automatic saving and loading of session on Emacs startup when it is set to with-desktop-registry-automatic .		
List registry of session/desktops	<f11> S R l	(desktop-registry-list-desktops)	Display a list of registered desktops inside a "Desktop Registry" buffer. The following command keys are available in this buffer: - A desktop-registry-add-current-desktop - R desktop-registry-rename-desktop - a desktop-registry-add-directory - d desktop-registry-remove-desktop - o desktop-registry-change-desktop
Add a director-identified session to the sessions/desktops registry	<f11> S R a	(desktop-registry-add-directory DIR &optional NAME)	Add DIR to the desktop registry, possibly using NAME. - Prompts for DIRectory. - With universal argument (‘C–u’), also prompt for a name. - This is useful when the directory name is not the project name or when it would result in duplicate entries in 'desktop-registry-registry'.
Add current session to the session/desktop registry	<f11> S R A	(desktop-registry-add-current-desktop &optional NAME)	Add the currently opened desktop file to 'desktop-registry-registry'. - If NAME is specified use that as the name for the registry entry. - With universal argument (‘C–u’), also prompt for a name. - This is useful when the directory name is not the project name or when it would result in duplicate entries in 'desktop-registry-registry'.
Remove the session/desktop from the registry	<f11> S R d	(desktop-registry-remove-desktop DESKTOP)	Remove desktop. If cursor is in the "Desktop Registry" buffer, on a desktop name in the desktop list, the current desktop is used, otherwise the command prompts for the desktop name (with completion support).
Change current session/desktop to the name specified in registry	<f11> S R o	(desktop-registry-change-desktop NAME)	Change to the desktop named NAME. - If cursor is in the "Desktop Registry" buffer, on a desktop name in the desktop list this desktop name is used, otherwise the command prompts for the desktop name (with completion support). - This function just calls 'desktop-change-dir' with the directory attached to NAME.
Rename session/desktop in registry	<f11> S R R	(desktop-registry-rename-desktop OLD NEW)	Rename desktop OLD to NEW. If cursor is in the "Desktop Registry" buffer, on a desktop name in the desktop list, the listed desktop is used as OLD, otherwise the command prompts for the OLD desktop name (with completion support). It always prompts for the NEW desktop name.
Using desktop+ commands explicitly	With  desktop+ and  pel-use-desktop set to with-desktop+ , the following commands are also bound to the following secondary keys sequences.  These can also be accessed via the main key sequences <f11> S L and <f11> S S but you may have to answer prompts to select the command.		
Save session with a specific name	<f11> S + s	(desktop+-create NAME)	Create a new session, identified by a name. - The session is created in a subdirectory of 'desktop+-base-dir'. - It can afterwards be reloaded using 'desktop+-load'. - As a special case, if NAME is left blank, the session is automatically named after the current working directory.
Load session identified by name	<f11> S + l	(desktop+-load NAME)	Load a session previously created using 'desktop+-create'. - NAME is the name which was given at session creation. When called interactively, it is asked in the minibuffer with auto-completion. - As a special case, if NAME is left blank, the session is automatically named after the current working directory.
Save current session named after current directory	<f11> S + S	(desktop+-create-auto)	Create a new session, identified by the current working directory. - The session is created in a subdirectory of 'desktop+-base-dir'. - It can afterwards be reloaded using 'desktop+-load'.
Load session previously created for the current directory	<f11> S + L	(desktop+-load-auto)	Load a session previously created using 'desktop+-create-auto'. The session is identified by the current working directory.
Using easysession.el commands explicitly	With  easysession.el and  pel-use-easysession turned on the following commands are also bound to the following key sequences.		
Delete easysession sessions.	<f11> S E D	(easysession-delete SESSION-NAMES)	Delete one or more sessions. SESSION-NAMES is a string or a list of session names.
Rename the current easysession session	<f11> S E R	(easysession-rename NEW-SESSION-NAME)	Rename the current session. NEW-SESSION-NAME is the session name.
Unload current easysession session	<f11> S E U	(easysession-unload)	Unload the currently loaded session. - If a session is active and marked as loaded, the session state is saved before unloading. - The function then clears all internal indicators of an active session by resetting the current session identifier and load flag. - This operation only affects in-memory state. Session data on disk is preserved.
Toggle easysession saving the session setup when switching session.	<f11> S E M-s	(pel-easysession-toggle-save-on-switch)	Toggle saving session when switching.
Toggle saving the easysession session state when closing Emacs	<f11> S E M-S	(pel-easysession-toggle-save-on-exit)	Toggle the ‘easysession-save-mode’ mode global minor mode. When the mode is active easysession stores the current session when Emacs exists.
Save easysession session when in Emacs daemon server Only available in Emacs daemon client.	<f11> S E <f4> M-c	(easysession-save-session-and-close-frames &optional ARGS)	Save the session and close all frames without stopping the Emacs daemon. If ARG is non-nil (for instance, when called with a prefix argument), silently save all file-visiting buffers without prompting the user. - Useful in daemon mode, this simulates quitting Emacs: buffers are saved, the EasySession state is saved, and all frames except the initial terminal frame are closed. - From the perspective of EasySession, this is functionally equivalent to an application shutdown: the session is fully saved and unloaded. When a new frame is later initialized by the Emacs daemon, EasySession restores the state as if the process had been freshly started.
Edit the current easysession session data file.	<f11> S E <f4> M-e	(easysession-edit SESSION-NAME)	Edit a session in 'emacs-lisp-mode'. - If SESSION-NAME is nil, defaults to the current session. - Signal an error if the session file does not exist. - Returns the buffer visiting the session file. - The buffer is read-only if ‘easysession-edit-read-only’ is non-nil. That can be activated via the pel-use-easysession options.
Reset the session	<f11> S E <f4> M-r	(pel-easysession-reset)	 Prompt and on request: kill all buffers and close all frames, tabs, and windows.

Sessions — References

Topic & link	Description
GNU Emacs Manual - Saving Emacs Sessions	Describes Emacs built-in desktop session management feature.
desktop+	The external package desktop+, hosted on Github and on the MELPA package archive, that extends Emacs session management desktop.el by providing the ability to control sessions by name instead of having to rely on the directory location where save sessions were stored. It also allows saving/restoring several types of buffers, which are not supported by the other packages.
desktop-registry	Another package that extends the built-in desktop.el with a registry of desktops (sessions).